CREW DEVELOPMENT INSTITUTE

CDI

Sponsorship Partnership

Building Africa's live event production workforce through world-class training, mentorship, and real-world experience.

The Opportunity

Africa's stages are ready to shine—but they need trained crews.

85%

of African live events rely on imported technical crews

$2B+

annual production spending leaves the continent

$5B+

projected African music industry value by 2026

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formal production training programs in most West African markets

International productions fly in crews at massive cost while local talent remains untrained and underemployed. CDI exists to change that.

What CDI Does

A comprehensive ecosystem for technical production training

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Learning Arm

School programs and hands-on training for local technicians in lighting, audio, video, and rigging. University partnerships across three continents.

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Technical Advisory

On-site and virtual production management. Industry professionals mentoring and supporting local crews on real productions.

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Production Arm

Direct production support during transition, phasing out as local teams become self-sufficient. Building capacity for world-class events.

Impact & Vision

Your investment creates a multiplier effect: each trained technician supports 5+ additional jobs, elevates production quality, and keeps revenue on the continent.

100+
Stagehands trained per quarter

60-120
Specialist technicians per cohort

3-5x
Wage increase for certified technicians

85%
Target graduate employment rate

Training Tracks: Audio (FOH/Monitor, system design, RF) • Lighting (GrandMA3, rigging, show design) • Video (LED walls, camera ops, Resolume) • Rigging (safety, load-in, operations)

Partnership Tiers

Choose the level that aligns with your impact goals

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Bronze Partner

$2,500/yr

- ✓ Logo on CDI website
- ✓ Quarterly newsletter mention
- ✓ Annual Impact Report
- ✓ Certificate of Partnership
- ✓ Virtual year-end celebration

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Silver Partner

$5,000/yr

- ✓ Prominent website placement
- ✓ Logo on training materials

- ✓ Quarterly social media features
- ✓ Named workshop sponsor
- ✓ Virtual site visit

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Gold Partner

$10,000/yr

- ✓ Named cohort sponsor
- ✓ Logo on trainee gear
- ✓ Monthly progress reports
- ✓ First access to hire graduates
- ✓ Speaking at graduation

💎

Platinum Partner

$25,000+/yr

- ✓ Naming rights opportunity
- ✓ Board-level advisory input

- ✓ Curriculum co-development
- ✓ Exclusive hiring pipeline
- ✓ VIP festival hospitality

Leadership Team

Seasoned professionals building Africa's technical production future

EH

Founder & Executive Director

15+ years across concert touring, television, and film. IATSE 728 member. CBU Professor. Designed for Fantasia, Amaarae, The Isley Brothers, Anita Baker, and Ledisi.

KB

Lighting Designer & Visual Director

Experience spanning film, television, high-profile national events, and concert touring for top-tier artists across hip-hop, R&B, and soul.

BB

Producer & Operations Leader

10+ years specializing in technical direction, stage management, and live event production. Expert in LED wall systems and sustainable infrastructure.

Local Operations Partner

Illumin8 Academy • Accra, Ghana

Our on-the-ground partner providing facilities, equipment storage, local recruitment, and ongoing crew deployment across West Africa.

Join Us in Building Africa's Future

Your partnership directly funds equipment, training, mentorship, and sustainable infrastructure for the next generation of African production professionals.

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Partner With Us

CDI is a 501(c)(3) nonprofit organization. All donations are tax-deductible to the extent allowed by law.